Listing 5.3 `parallel_functions.py` (recommend function)

```
def recommend(topic, rating="good"):
    if "time travel" in topic.lower():     #1
        return json.dumps({"topic": "time travel",
                           "recommendation": "Back to the Future",
                           "rating": rating})
    elif "recipe" in topic.lower():    #1
        return json.dumps({"topic": "recipe",
                           "recommendation": "The best thing … ate.",
                           "rating": rating})
    elif "gift" in topic.lower():      #1
        return json.dumps({"topic": "gift",
                           "recommendation": "A glorious new...",
                           "rating": rating})
    else:     #2
        return json.dumps({"topic": topic,
                           "recommendation": "unknown"})     #3
```

#1 Checks to see if the string is contained within the topic input
#2 If no topic is detected, returns the default
#3 Returns a JSON object

Next, we'll look at the function called `run_conversation`, where all the work starts with the request construction.